Henley Business School (Whiteknights) Assignment Brief

Module Code and Title	IC101 Introductory Securities & Markets
Academic Year	2026/27
Module Convenor	Professor George Alexandridis
Type of Assessment	Report
Weighting of Assessment	50%
Individual or Group Assessment	☒ Individual ☐ Group
Module Convenor Office Hours/Opportunities for advice and feedback	Normal office hours

1. Submission details

Submission deadline	11/01/2027
Submission point	☒ Blackboard ☒ Turnitin ☐ Other: Report via Turnitin (PDF); data workbook via Blackboard (Excel).
Item(s) to be submitted	A report (PDF) and the completed data workbook (Excel), with your LSEG Workspace screenshots on the Evidence tab.
File type	☒ PDF ☐ Word ☐ PPT ☒ Excel ☐ Video ☐ Other:
Formatting guidelines	Use headings and the required sections below; include your data table and refer to your figures in the text.
Structure (e.g. required sub-sections)	1) Introduction and company choice (150 words). 2) The data: your company versus a peer, from LSEG Workspace (250 words). 3) What the numbers say: carbon intensity versus peer and sector benchmark, the ESG and Environmental pillar scores, and the emissions externality (400 words). 4) The company's transition and how it is, or should be, financed (500 words). 5) Recommendation and conclusion (200 words).
Size of assessment (word limit or length) and penalty applied	1,500 words (excluding the data table, references and the workbook). Submissions more than 10% below the word count will lose marks; the marker will not mark material exceeding the word count by more than 10%.
Referencing style	☒ Harvard ☐ Other:

2. What is the purpose of this assessment?

The following table shows which of the module learning outcomes are being assessed in this assignment. Use this table to help you see the connection between this assessment and your learning on the module.

Module learning outcomes to be assessed
Critically discuss how the finance industry is changing regarding environmental, social and governance issues, and how the finance industry can help mitigate climate change.

3. What is the task for this assessment?

Task **(attach an assignment brief if required)**	Choose ONE large listed company that interests you (a constituent of a major index such as the FTSE 100, S&P 500 or STOXX 600, so that its data is fully covered in LSEG Workspace), and ONE peer in the same sector for comparison. Every student completes the same task; only the company differs. Using the provided Excel workbook, pull five figures from LSEG Workspace for each company (latest revenue, the overall LSEG ESG score, the LSEG Environmental pillar score, and Scope 1 and Scope 2 emissions), evidencing each with a dated screenshot. The workbook computes the comparison for you. You then write a 1,500-word report, following the required sections, on what the data say about your company's climate transition and how that transition is, or should be, financed.

4. What is required of me in this assessment?

Guidelines/details of how to prepare your submission	Guidelines: among other things, comment on: • your company's carbon intensity, and how it compares with the peer and the sector benchmark; • the LSEG ESG score and Environmental pillar score, and what they add (or do not add) to the emissions picture; • the scale of the company's emissions externality at the social cost of carbon (use the UK DESNZ 2025/26 central value of GBP 273 per tonne, provided in the workbook; note that published estimates vary widely and say why that matters), relative to its revenue; • the company's net-zero or science-based target and how credible it looks (from the company's own report); • how the company's transition is, or should be, financed: green versus transition bonds, transition finance, and the influence of its banks and shareholders; • any evidence of greenwashing (its claims versus your data).
Expectations for group work (if applicable)	Not applicable (individual assessment).

Self-regulation: Make sure that you…	Do the Workspace data pull and screenshots early; the best reports leave time to research the company's transition after the data is in.
Three key pieces of advice based on the feedback given to the previous cohort who completed this assignment	1. Pull and screenshot your Workspace figures early, and read the company's annual and sustainability reports carefully. 2. Link your comments to the course material and concepts wherever possible. 3. Address the required report sections accurately.
Formative assessment opportunities/activities	Weekly Blackboard quizzes; seminars; and a Workspace data drop-in.

5. What resources might I use to prepare my work?

LSEG Workspace, especially the ESG analytics, is your primary data source; the workbook lists exactly which five figures to pull. Use the Sustainable Finance lecture slides and the module textbook, Financing the Energy Transition, for the concepts (green versus transition bonds, transition finance, the social cost of carbon, science-based targets, the funding gap). The company's own annual and sustainability reports, the ICMA Green and Social Bond Principles, the CFA Institute, the FCA and the Financial Times are good supporting sources. Try to include some academic references.

6. Academic integrity

Guidance on academic misconduct (including using Turnitin practice area)	The work you produce must be your own or that of members of your group if it is a group assessment. It must not have been submitted as part of other assessments, at this or another institution. You should ensure that the work you produce adheres to the University's statement on academic integrity and to the regulations regarding academic misconduct (such as plagiarism and cheating). You can find information about this at: University of Reading Academic misconduct policies. You are encouraged to put a draft of your work through the Turnitin practice area to satisfy yourself that the work is your own original work. You can seek advice from the Module Convenor.

Use of Generative Artificial Intelligence (GenAI) tools *What do we mean by GenAI? GenAI tools create new content in the form of text, code, images, videos, music etc. The most common GenAI tools at the time of writing are ChatGPT, CoPilot, Claude, Llama and Gemini. Please note that this list is not exhaustive. Please refer to the article **here** which frequently updates its list of well-known GenAI tools.	There are three categories of GenAI use in assessments in operation at the University of Reading. The ticked box below indicates which category this assignment belongs to: ☐ 1. GenAI tools cannot be used in any way in the assessment ☒ 2. GenAI tools can be used to support student learning and development (to sketch initial ideas, find sources, explore unfamiliar concepts, provide structure etc.) ☐ 3. The use of GenAI tools is actively encouraged to help students develop their skills in the use of such tools and understand how their use can be incorporated into authentic writing tasks. Specifically: If option 2. or 3. above is checked, you **must** include a statement to acknowledge your use of GenAI tools* within the assessment itself. This statement should be written in complete sentences and include the following information: • Name and version of the GenAI tool used; e.g. ChatGPT-3.5 • Publisher (company that provides the GenAI system); e.g. OpenAI • URL of the AI tool (if applicable) • Brief description (single sentence) of the way in which the GenAI tool was used • Confirmation that the work is your own *For example:* *I acknowledge the use of ChatGPT 3.5 (OpenAI, https://chat.openai.com/) to generate an outline for background study. I confirm that no output generated by GenAI has been presented as my own work.* **Note:** if you have not used GenAI tools to help with your assessment, you must still include a statement to acknowledge this fact, e.g. *I declare that no GenAI tools have been used to produce this work.* The **misuse of GenAI tools**, including the failure to appropriately acknowledge the use of such tools, is considered academic misconduct and carries sanctions, as detailed in the Assessment Handbook. Please also refer to **student guidance** on Using Generative AI Tools at University and GenAI and University Study
Academic misconduct penalties	☒ The University's standard policy on academic misconduct applies. ☐ Other:

7. Late Submission Arrangements

Late submission point	☐ Blackboard ☒ Turnitin ☐ Other:

Late submission penalties	☒ The University's standard penalties apply. See Standard Penalties. ☐ Other:

8. Feedback Arrangements

Timing of feedback	☒ Within 15 days of submission deadline ☐ When examination marks are released ☐ Other:
Type of feedback	☒ Mark ☒ Generic feedback ☐ Individual feedback ☐ Breakdown of mark ☐ Audio feedback ☐ Video feedback ☐ Comments written on the submitted work ☐ Other:
Location of feedback	☒ Blackboard ☐ Turnitin ☐ Other:

9. Assessment criteria rubric for marking

Assessment criteria	**80+ Outstanding**	**70–79 Excellent**	**60–69 Very good**	**50–59 Good**	**49 and below Satisfactory**	**39 and below**
Understanding of relevant academic theory and concepts (30%)	Outstanding knowledge of the academic and a wider range of material, with strong command of detail and theory; full understanding of the relevance of these points.	Excellent knowledge and understanding of key theory and evidence; evidence of wider reading of relevant sources.	Very good knowledge of theory and concepts; some evidence of wider reading.	Sound knowledge relevant to the theory/topic, including some wider reading.	Basic knowledge or understanding; limited wider reading; may have some factual or other errors.	Very limited knowledge of the relevant theories and concepts; possibly significant errors of understanding.
Application of academic theories/concepts in the report (30%)	Applies theory to practical concerns in a nuanced, balanced way; strong awareness of context and how it affects the applicability of any theory.	Applies key points from theory to practical implications; excellent awareness of the importance of context.	Very good application of theories and concepts, with good awareness of context.	Sound application of theories and concepts, with reasonable awareness of context.	Concepts and theories linked to the analysis but in a limited way; limited awareness of context.	Weak or very limited attempts to apply theory and concepts to practice.
Originality: evidence of original thinking / approach (20%)	Perceptive, critical and original thinking that adds value; novel interpretations or arguments; well-argued personal	Evidence of original thinking and approaches that add value; well-argued personal views that enhance the report.	Well-argued personal views based on evidence and data; good attempts at original thinking.	Some expression of personal views; some attempt at original thinking.	Limited personal views, may lack conviction or evidence; little original thinking.	Little or no well-argued personal views; no credible attempt at original thinking.

	views that may be non-consensus.					
Scholarship and academic practice: reading and referencing (10%)	Exceptionally wide reading; excellent command of the literature and well-chosen non-academic sources; referencing full and consistent with no errors.	Excellent range of reading and independent study; firm basis in the literature; referencing full, consistent, correctly Harvard-formatted.	Wide range of good-quality academic and non-academic sources; referencing full, consistent, correctly formatted.	Good range of reading and independent study; referencing generally correctly formatted.	Limited reading beyond course material and the company report; some unreliable sources; references may be limited or quotes over-used.	No or very limited range of reading; references may be incorrectly formatted.
Structure and presentation: clarity and flow (10%)	Engaging, clear and precise even on technical subjects; no errors; all structural elements present; flows well with smooth transitions.	Very clearly written and presented; no spelling or grammar errors; well-structured with excellent flow.	Well presented and properly structured; clear writing; only very minor grammatical errors; good flow.	All required elements and good structure; clear writing with minor issues of structure, flow or grammar.	Somewhat awkward and difficult to follow; some spelling or grammar mistakes; structure unclear; flow not smooth.	Difficult to read; numerous serious errors; no clear structure.